

Middle East Daily Brief

June 30, 2026

Executive summary

8 stories from 6 outlets (6 perspectives) over the reporting window. Leading the day: US and Iran agree to halt Strait of Hormuz attacks, set Doha talks as both sides 'stand down for now'.

Top stories

1. **US and Iran agree to halt Strait of Hormuz attacks, set Doha talks as both sides 'stand down for now'** *CBS News, Al Jazeera, Arab News, Fox News, New York Times, RFE/RL, Reuters, Times of Israel* • corroborated by 8 outlets After a weekend of tit-for-tat strikes near the Strait of Hormuz, US and Iranian officials agreed to halt attacks and let vessels 'move freely,' with a US official saying both sides would 'stand down for now.' Washington said technical... <https://www.cbsnews.com/live-updates/us-iran-war-peace-talks-timetable-unclear-strait-of-hormuz-clashes/>
2. **Iran strikes Bahrain and Kuwait after US attacks, threatens to end negotiations; Qatari citizen killed by shrapnel** *Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, Arab News, CNN, Gulf News, Reuters* • corroborated by 6 outlets Iran fired drones and missiles at targets in Bahrain and Kuwait in response to US strikes, damaging a residential building in Manama and prompting Gulf states to condemn the escalation as a test of the fragile US-Iran ceasefire. Qatar... <https://www.timesofisrael.com/iran-attacks-bahrain-and-kuwait-following-us-strikes-threatens-to-end-negotiations/>
3. **Iran's foreign minister calls for Gulf security framework as Tehran set to receive \$6bn in frozen assets** *Arab News, Al Arabiya, Iran International, Reuters* • corroborated by 4 outlets Iran's foreign minister called for the establishment of a joint security framework with Gulf Arab states, an appeal made just hours after Iranian forces struck Bahrain and Kuwait, underscoring Tehran's attempt to pair coercion with... <https://www.arabnews.com/>
4. **Israeli forces detonate explosives in south Lebanon village and strike Gaza's Deir el-Balah amid 'ceasefire'** *Al Jazeera, Agence France-Presse, Middle East Eye* • corroborated by 3 outlets A massive Israeli-triggered explosion shook the southern Lebanese village of Majdal Zoun, the latest in a series of demolitions and strikes that residents and Lebanese authorities describe as repeated violations of the truce. In Gaza, an... <https://www.aljazeera.com/middle-east/>
5. **Israel demolishes 200-metre Hezbollah tunnel and strikes south Lebanon command posts despite framework deal** *Times of Israel, Agence France-Presse, Al Jazeera* • corroborated by 3 outlets The Israeli military said it demolished a Hezbollah tunnel stretching more than 200 metres and reaching over 25 metres deep, describing it as a drone facility that held hundreds of weapons and launch shafts, and struck Hezbollah command... <https://www.timesofisrael.com/annex-in-israel-lebanon-deal-assures-idf-freedom-of-action-in-security-zone-source/>
6. **Druze leader warns of 'quiet massacre' of Druze in Syria's Sweida, urges Western action** *Middle East Eye, Al Arabiya, Arab News* • corroborated by 3 outlets Sheikh Mowafaq Tarif, spiritual leader of Israel's Druze community, called on the United States and Europe to halt what he

described as a 'quiet massacre' of Druze in Sweida, southern Syria, saying thousands were killed in 2025 and... <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news>

By theme

Israel – Gaza & the Palestinians

- **Palestinian UN envoy says 'time for condemning is over,' demands end to Israeli annexation** – Middle East Monitor, Arab News <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260629-time-for-condemning-is-over-palestines-un-envoy-demands-end-to-israeli-annexation-of-palestinian-land/>
- **Israeli forces raid Birzeit University in occupied West Bank, assault security guard** – Middle East Monitor, Al Jazeera <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260629-israeli-forces-raid-palestinian-university-assault-security-guard-in-occupied-west-bank/>

Iran & the US

- **US and Iran agree to halt Strait of Hormuz attacks, set Doha talks as both sides 'stand down for now'** – CBS News, Al Jazeera, Arab News, Fox News, New York Times, RFE/RL, Reuters, Times of Israel <https://www.cbsnews.com/live-updates/us-iran-war-peace-talks-timetable-unclear-strait-of-hormuz-clashes/>
- **Iran's foreign minister calls for Gulf security framework as Tehran set to receive \$6bn in frozen assets** – Arab News, Al Arabiya, Iran International, Reuters <https://www.arabnews.com/>

Lebanon & Hezbollah

- **Israel demolishes 200-metre Hezbollah tunnel and strikes south Lebanon command posts despite framework deal** – Times of Israel, Agence France-Presse, Al Jazeera <https://www.timesofisrael.com/annex-in-israel-lebanon-deal-assures-idf-freedom-of-action-in-security-zone-source/>

Syria & Iraq

- **Druze leader warns of 'quiet massacre' of Druze in Syria's Sweida, urges Western action** – Middle East Eye, Al Arabiya, Arab News <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news>

Gulf & Arabian Peninsula

- **Iran strikes Bahrain and Kuwait after US attacks, threatens to end negotiations; Qatari citizen killed by shrapnel** – Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, Arab News, CNN, Gulf News, Reuters <https://www.timesofisrael.com/iran-attacks-bahrain-and-kuwait-following-us-strikes-threatens-to-end-negotiations/>

Israel – politics & society

- **Israeli forces detonate explosives in south Lebanon village and strike Gaza's Deir el-Balah amid 'ceasefire'** – Al Jazeera, Agence France-Presse, Middle East Eye <https://www.aljazeera.com/middle-east/>

Perspective balance

Perspective	Stories
Israeli	2
pro-Palestinian	2
international	1
Saudi	1
Qatari	1
independent	1

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